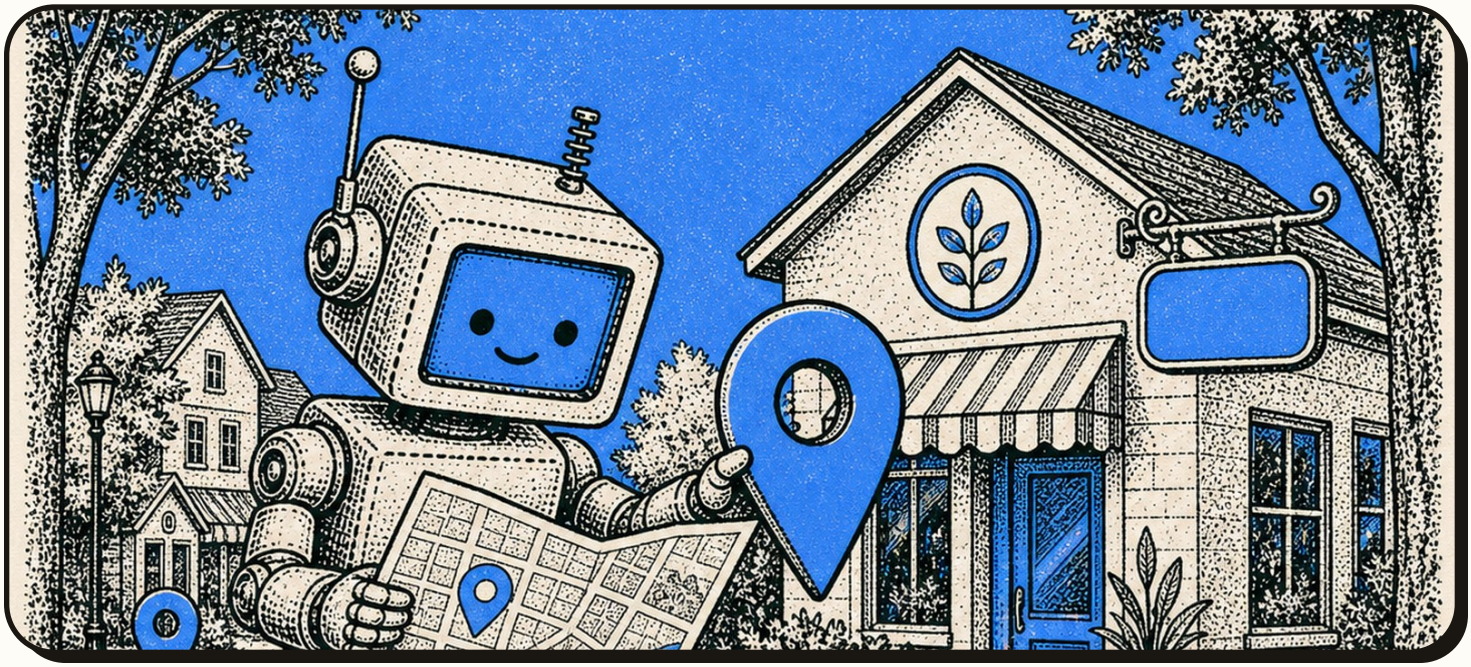
Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE + LOCAL SEO CHECKLIST

A local visibility audit for naturopathic practices



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Strengthen relevance, trust, and local prominence across Google Business Profile, your website, accurate listings, and the wider web while following Ontario advertising rules.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Get the business identity right first.

A complete local profile begins with accurate ownership, naming, and categorization.

1 Claim, verify, and secure the correct profile

WHY IT MATTERS

Confirm that the practice is eligible, claim the right listing, complete verification, remove or resolve duplicates, and protect owner access with current account security.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The correct profile is claimed and verified
- [ ] Duplicate profiles are resolved
- [ ] Primary owners and managers are current
- [ ] Account recovery and security are documented

QUICK TEST Could the practice recover control of its profile today?

2 Use an accurate name and primary category

WHY IT MATTERS

Use the real-world business name without added keywords. Choose the most accurate primary category, then add only secondary categories that reflect services actually offered.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Business name matches real-world branding
- [ ] No keywords are added to the name
- [ ] Primary category describes the core business
- [ ] Secondary categories are accurate and limited

QUICK TEST Would a new patient immediately understand what this business is?

Complete every useful practice detail.

Accurate information helps Google match the profile and helps patients choose confidently.

3 Complete contact, hours, and booking information

WHY IT MATTERS

Keep the address or service area, phone, website, appointment link, regular hours, special hours, and accessibility details complete and current.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Address or service area is accurate
- [ ] Phone and website links work
- [ ] Appointment link opens the right booking flow
- [ ] Regular and special hours stay current

QUICK TEST Could a patient call, visit, or book without encountering stale information?

4 Describe services and useful profile attributes

WHY IT MATTERS

Add the services patients actually search for, with clear and compliant descriptions. Complete relevant attributes without stretching categories or making unsupported claims.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Core services are listed individually
- [ ] Descriptions use patient-friendly language
- [ ] Relevant attributes are completed
- [ ] Services match what the website offers

QUICK TEST Does the profile fully explain what someone can book?

Show a real, active practice.

Authentic imagery and compliant profile stewardship make the listing more useful without relying on testimonials.

5 Publish authentic photos and videos

WHY IT MATTERS

Use current images of the exterior, entrance, reception, treatment environment, practitioners, and accessibility features. Avoid stock imagery that could misrepresent the location.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Exterior and entrance are recognizable
- [ ] Interior photos reflect the current space
- [ ] Practitioner images are professional and current
- [ ] Accessibility features are visible where relevant

QUICK TEST Would a first-time visitor recognize the clinic when they arrive?

6 Do not solicit or promote patient reviews

WHY IT MATTERS

CONO treats public patient reviews as testimonials. Do not ask patients to post them, use review badges or widgets, reproduce review text, or direct visitors to review content.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] No review requests are sent
- [ ] No review badge or widget is displayed
- [ ] No patient review text is reused
- [ ] Staff understand the restriction

QUICK TEST Could any part of the process encourage or promote a patient testimonial?

Connect the profile to a strong local website.

Local visibility improves when the profile, website, directories, and real-world practice agree.

7 Manage unsolicited reviews under CONO guidance

WHY IT MATTERS

Where a platform will not disable reviews, document reasonable attempts to request removal. Do not amplify the review, confirm a clinical relationship, discuss care, or use the content elsewhere.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Removal requests are documented
- [ ] No clinical relationship is confirmed
- [ ] Review content is not republished
- [ ] Privacy and escalation steps are clear

QUICK TEST Can the practice show reasonable steps without amplifying the testimonial?

8 Match the website and profile details

WHY IT MATTERS

Point the profile to the most useful local page and keep the business name, address, phone, hours, services, booking destination, and practitioner details aligned.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Profile links to the best local landing page
- [ ] Name, address, and phone match
- [ ] Hours and services agree
- [ ] LocalBusiness data reflects visible information

QUICK TEST Would Google and a patient see one consistent business entity?

Build local recognition and monitor it.

Relevant links, accurate citations, current information, and ongoing measurement strengthen local prominence.

9 Strengthen legitimate local prominence

WHY IT MATTERS

Earn accurate listings and relevant mentions from professional associations, local organizations, trusted directories, community partners, and useful editorial coverage.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Key professional listings are accurate
- [ ] Local directories use consistent details
- [ ] Relevant organizations link to the site
- [ ] Inauthentic mentions are avoided

QUICK TEST Do trusted local sources confirm this practice exists and matters?

10 Review profile performance every month

WHY IT MATTERS

Track searches, views, calls, website visits, booking actions, photo freshness, profile edits, unsolicited public content, and policy alerts. Assign ownership before problems become urgent.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Profile performance is reviewed monthly
- [ ] Booking and website actions are tracked
- [ ] New edits and alerts are checked
- [ ] One person owns ongoing maintenance

QUICK TEST Can you explain which profile actions lead to appointments?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

10

Ready to compound

Maintain the standard, measure outcomes, and keep improving.

Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

Want a second set of eyes?

Book a free 20-minute website review and walk through the checklist together.

BOOK A FREE CALL ->

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MEMBER NOTE: Educational only - not CONO approval or legal advice; registrants remain responsible for current standards, scope, and advertising.

GUIDANCE USED CONO: Online reviews | CONO: Advertising guideline | Google: Improve local ranking